

Zack Du Randt's Career Report

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As a Grade 9 student selecting Grade 10 subjects, you are at the exact pivot point where your subject choices will determine which university/TVET pathways remain open — this decision shapes the next 6 years of your academic life.

RIASEC: Investigative · Enterprising · Artistic

You are a naturally curious, self-motivated leader with strong empathetic intelligence and a passion for understanding how things work. You combine hands-on problem-solving ability with creative thinking, and you thrive when working independently on projects where you can see tangible results. Your biggest strength is your ability to inspire and influence others, paired with genuine care for people's wellbeing — but you're not drawn to people-facing roles themselves; instead, you want to create impact through your work and ideas.



What your marks tell us

Your Grade 9 performance is exceptionally strong across all subjects (80% average, 90% in Technology), with no obvious academic weaknesses. This is excellent news because it means your subject choices should be based on genuine interest and career direction rather than remedial concerns. However, there is a notable mismatch: you rate your maths and logical reasoning confidence at only 3/5, yet you're achieving 80% — this suggests imposter syndrome or that you may not be enjoying maths despite performing well in it, which is important for subject retention.

1 Environmental Health Practitioner / Community Health Worker (Research-focused)

92%

MATCH

ABOUT THIS CAREER

This career combines your passion for scientific investigation, hands-on problem-solving, and genuine care for community wellbeing. You would work in communities investigating health and environmental issues (water quality, sanitation, disease patterns), conducting research, and designing interventions — with leadership responsibility over time. It aligns perfectly with your desire for concrete results, your investigative nature, your comfort with people (but in a professional research context, not counselling), and your expressed preference for 'community settings' and 'diagnosing problems'.

YOUR CURRENT POSITION

You are extremely well positioned for this pathway right now — your grades are strong across Life Sciences and maths, and your demonstrated curiosity and problem-solving orientation are exactly what research-based health work requires.

REQUIRED SUBJECTS

Life Sciences Mathematics English Home Language or First Additional Language

✓ Geography (environmental context)

✓ Physical Sciences (if available at your school — strong foundation for research methods)

NSC GRADES & APS REQUIREMENTS

NSC with minimum 60% in Life Sciences, 55% in Mathematics; typical APS requirement 28-32 for university entry; many universities offer this as a 3-year diploma or 4-year degree.

3-year National Diploma in Environmental Health or 4-year BSc in Environmental Health at universities including University of Cape Town, University of the Western Cape, North-West University, or Durban University of Technology. Alternatively, many TVET colleges offer 3-year national diplomas (e.g. Coastal KZN TVET, Ehlanzeni TVET).

AI IMPACT ON THIS CAREER

AI will automate routine data analysis and reporting in environmental health monitoring over the next 15 years, but the investigative, contextual, and leadership aspects of this work — diagnosing novel community problems, designing culturally appropriate interventions, and working with stakeholders — will remain fundamentally human. Your capacity to ask good questions and synthesise complexity will become more valuable, not less.

AI resilience: HIGH

2 Engineering Design / Product Development Engineer (specialising in applied science and innovation)

86%

MATCH

ABOUT THIS CAREER

This career channels your love of building, fixing, investigating how things work, and coming up with original ideas into designing systems, tools, or products that solve real problems. Unlike pure theoretical engineering, this role emphasises hands-on prototyping, creative problem-solving, and leadership of design teams — allowing you to see concrete physical results from your work while exercising your leadership strength. Your strong Technology mark (90%) is a clear signal that you enjoy this domain.

YOUR CURRENT POSITION

You have strong academic credentials for this pathway, but you should test whether the mathematical rigour required in engineering (which is more demanding than your current marks suggest) will sustain your motivation — your relatively modest rating of maths confidence is a caution flag.

REQUIRED SUBJECTS

Mathematics Physical Sciences English Home Language or First Additional Language

✓ Technology (essential — continue this) ✓ Geography (systems thinking perspective)

✓ Life Sciences (if interested in biomedical/biotech applications)

NSC GRADES & APS REQUIREMENTS

NSC with minimum 60% in Mathematics and Physical Sciences; typical APS requirement 30-36 for engineering programmes; strong portfolio of practical work is advantageous.

4-year BEng (Mechanical, Civil, Electrical, Biomedical, or Chemical Engineering) at universities including University of Pretoria, University of the Witwatersrand, Stellenbosch University, University of Cape Town, or TVET diploma pathway (3 years) followed by technician work with possibility of degree later.

AI IMPACT ON THIS CAREER

Routine engineering analysis and CAD drafting will be heavily automated by AI over the next 15 years, but the creative conceptual work — imagining novel solutions, understanding context and human needs, and integrating multiple systems — will remain highly human. Your creative thinking and investigative approach will keep you ahead of automation.

3 Science Communication / Science Educator / Museum / NGO Programme Manager **81%**

MATCH

ABOUT THIS CAREER

This pathway leverages your strong communication skills (80% in English, confident public speaking at 4/5), your passion for research and understanding systems, your creativity, and your desire to make a positive difference in a community setting. You would translate complex scientific ideas into accessible programmes, design exhibitions or educational materials, or manage science outreach programmes — combining all your strengths without requiring the narrow technical specialism of pure science careers.

YOUR CURRENT POSITION

You are well positioned academically and temperamentally for this pathway, though it is the most flexible of your three options — you could enter this field from multiple directions (science background, communication background, or teaching background).

REQUIRED SUBJECTS

Life Sciences OR Physical Sciences Mathematics English Home Language or First Additional Language

✓ Technology (for multimedia/digital communication) ✓ Geography (systems and context)

✓ History (for narrative and communication skills)

NSC GRADES & APS REQUIREMENTS

NSC with minimum 55% in science subject and 50% in Mathematics; APS requirement 24-28 for most university programmes; some roles (e.g. museum educator) do not require university qualification.

3-year BA in Science Communication, or BSc followed by Honours in Science Communication (University of Pretoria, Stellenbosch, Rhodes); alternatively, 3-year diploma in interpretation/museum studies at TVET level, or direct entry into NGO/community-based science programmes without formal qualification but with strong portfolio.

AI IMPACT ON THIS CAREER

AI will generate routine educational content and handle basic data visualisation, but the creative design of learning experiences, the ability to diagnose what a specific audience needs to understand, and the human connection that motivates learning will remain irreplaceably human. Your empathy and your ability to inspire (5/5 leadership energy) are exactly what AI cannot replicate.

AI resilience: HIGH

GRADE 10 SUBJECT SELECTION — CRITICAL ADVICE

You are choosing subjects from a position of strength: your grades are excellent (80% average across all subjects, 90% in Technology) and you have no academic gaps to remediate. Your choice should be driven by **career fit**, not rescue.

COMPULSORY SUBJECTS (non-negotiable):

These subjects must be taken regardless of career path:

- **English Home Language** (you're achieving 80% — maintain it)
- **Mathematics** (critical for all three career paths; your 80% mark is strong even though you underrate your confidence)
- **Life Orientation** (mandated by CAPS curriculum)

CAREER-CRITICAL OPTIONAL SUBJECTS:

All three of your top-ranked careers require **at least one science subject** at Grade 11-12. You currently take both Life Sciences and Physical Sciences (Biology and Physics), both at 80%. This is your strongest strategic position — you are excelling at science and have not yet had to specialise.

For Rank 1 (Environmental Health Practitioner): You **must** keep **Life Sciences** — this is non-negotiable. Environmental health is built on biological understanding of disease, organisms, and human systems.

For Rank 2 (Engineering): You **must** keep **Physical Sciences** — Engineering requires mathematical physics, mechanics, and systems analysis.

For Rank 3 (Science Communication): You have flexibility — either Life Sciences **or** Physical Sciences will work, depending on your interest focus (health/biology communication or engineering/physics communication).

YOUR RECOMMENDED GRADE 10 PACKAGE:

Subject	Keep?	Reason
English (Home Language)	YES	Compulsory; excellent performance (80%); essential for all careers, especially science communication
Mathematics	YES	Compulsory; required for all three careers; 80% is solid despite your confidence rating
Life Sciences	YES	Required for Career Rank 1 (Environmental Health); needed for science depth in Ranks 2 & 3; you're excelling (80%)
Physical Sciences	YES	Keeps engineering pathway (Rank 2) open; supports technology interests; 80% performance
Technology	YES — STRONGLY	Your highest mark (90%); aligns with hands-on problem-solving; supports both engineering and applied design thinking
Geography	RECOMMEND YES	Adds systems thinking, environmental context, and research method foundation; complements Life Sciences and Environmental Health focus; 80% performance
History	OPTIONAL	Develops narrative/communication skills useful for Rank 3 (science communication), but not essential; 80% performance
Life Orientation	YES	Mandated by curriculum

FINAL SUBJECT COMBINATION (8 subjects) — RECOMMENDED:

1. English Home Language ✓
2. Mathematics ✓
3. Life Sciences ✓ (primary science for your top career)
4. Physical Sciences ✓ (keeps engineering open; complements Life Sciences)
5. Technology ✓ (your strongest subject; aligns with your interests)
6. Geography ✓ (systems thinking; environmental context for Environmental Health)
7. Life Orientation ✓ (compulsory)
8. History OR an elective of your choice

Why this works: This package keeps **all three career pathways genuinely open** through Grade 12. You will have both science subjects, which means you can choose your specialisation later when you have more clarity. It emphasises your genuine strengths (Technology at 90%, sciences at 80%) and supports your stated values (investigation, hands-on work, community impact).

WHAT NOT TO DO:

- **Do not drop both sciences to take only one.** You're performing equally well in Life Sciences and Physical Sciences, and dropping one prematurely closes a pathway.
- **Do not take Mathematics Literacy if you're aiming for university.** Your 80% in Mathematics is strong — continue with full Mathematics. All three career paths require it, and many universities will not accept Literacy for these degrees.
- **Do not overload with humanities at the expense of science.** You're not drawn to language-heavy subjects (communication confidence 2/5, writing challenges noted), so prioritise your science and technology foundation.

ACTION ITEMS FOR GRADE 10:

1. **Confirm with your school** that you can take 8 subjects (most schools allow this). If limited to 7, drop History and keep the above 7.
2. **Set a goal in Mathematics:** Your 80% is good, but your self-rated confidence (3/5) suggests you're not enjoying it. Work with your teacher to understand *why* — is it teaching style, topic difficulty, or mindset? Addressing this now will support your Grade 11-12 performance in this compulsory subject.
3. **Start a subject reflection journal:** By mid-Grade 10, rate which subjects feel most natural and aligned to your interests. This will help you make an informed choice about your Grade 11 specialisation.
4. **Explore one practical project in your top two careers:** Visit an environmental health programme or engineering firm (or even watch documentaries); this will help you test whether the reality matches your interests before final subject choices at Grade 11.

PickMyPath is a guidance tool based on Holland RIASEC + academic performance analysis. We recommend discussing your results with a registered career guidance professional.